

Q1: Backend Architecture Overview

Question: Analyze the backend directory structure and give a high-level overview of the architecture. Identify the main entry point, the framework being used, and explain the purpose of the key directories. How is the application initialized?

Framework

FastAPI (Python 3.13+), running on **Uvicorn** (ASGI). Everything is `async/await` throughout — from DB queries to middleware to WebSocket handlers.

Entry Point — `app/main.py`

This is where the entire application is assembled. It does four things:

1. Lifespan (startup / shutdown)

```
@asynccontextmanager
async def lifespan(app: FastAPI):
    start_scheduler()           # APScheduler cron jobs
    await socket_manager.init_redis() # Redis Pub/Sub for WebSockets
    yield
    scheduler.shutdown()
    await socket_manager.redis.close()
    await engine.dispose()      # Clean DB connection pool teardown
```

Both the scheduler and Redis are started **non-critically** — if either fails, the API still serves requests normally.

2. Middleware Stack (applied bottom-up by Starlette)

Middleware	Purpose
CORSMiddleware	Allows <code>localhost:5173</code> , <code>localhost:3000</code> , etc.
SanitizationMiddleware	XSS prevention on all incoming JSON bodies
IdempotencyMiddleware	Deduplicates repeated POST requests via <code>Idempotency-Key</code> header

3. All 12 Routers Registered Under `/api/v1/`

4. Global Exception Handlers

- `RequestValidationError` → 422 with structured error detail

- Unhandled `Exception` → 500 with generic message (logged server-side)

Directory Structure & Purpose

app/	
main.py	← Application factory & entry point
core/	← Infrastructure: config, DB, security, sockets, rate limiting
api/	
deps.py	← Shared FastAPI dependencies (auth, role enforcement)
v1/	← All HTTP + WebSocket route handlers
models/	← SQLAlchemy ORM table definitions
schemas/	← Pydantic request/response models
services/	← Business logic (no HTTP awareness)
middleware/	← Custom ASGI middleware

`core/` — Infrastructure Layer

File	Purpose
config.py	Single <code>Settings</code> class (pydantic-settings) reads every env var from <code>.env</code> . One global <code>settings</code> singleton used everywhere.
database.py	Creates the async SQLAlchemy engine + session factory. Exports <code>get_db()</code> — an async generator injecting a DB session per request.
security.py	JWT creation/decoding (python-jose), bcrypt password hashing.
sockets.py	<code>ConnectionManager</code> — holds active WebSocket connections grouped by role (<code>ADMIN</code> / <code>MANAGER</code> / <code>DRIVER</code>), subscribes to Redis broadcast + <code>alerts</code> channels, routes messages to the correct role bucket. Has a self-healing supervisor that auto-reconnects if Redis drops.
rate_limit.py	Configures <code>slowapi</code> limiter instance used on sensitive endpoints.

`api/deps.py` — Dependency Injection (Auth & Authorization)

Three functions form a chain:

```
get_current_user()
    deps.get_current_active_user()
```

```
■■■ get_current_user_with_role("ADMIN" | "MANAGER" | "DRIVER")
```

Usage in any router is a single line:

```
user: User = Depends(get_current_user_with_role(UserRole.ADMIN))
```

Pre-built shortcuts: `get_current_admin_user` , `get_current_manager_user` , `get_current_driver_user` .

`api/v1/` — Route Handlers

12 router files, each focused on a role or domain:

File	Prefix	Audience
<code>auth.py</code>	<code>/api/v1/auth</code>	Everyone — login, refresh, signup, profile, change-password
<code>admin.py</code>	<code>/api/v1/admin</code>	ADMIN — dashboard stats, rotation creation
<code>users.py</code>	<code>/api/v1/admin/users</code>	ADMIN — user CRUD
<code>drivers.py</code>	<code>/api/v1/admin/drivers</code>	ADMIN — driver profiles
<code>vehicles.py</code>	<code>/api/v1/admin/vehicles</code>	ADMIN — vehicle fleet
<code>routes.py</code>	<code>/api/v1/admin/routes</code>	ADMIN — bus routes + stops
<code>tickets.py</code>	<code>/api/v1/admin/tickets</code>	ADMIN — passenger tickets
<code>manager_ops.py</code>	<code>/api/v1/manager</code>	MANAGER — live fleet, reroute approval
<code>manager.py</code>	<code>/api/v1/manager</code>	MANAGER — maintenance approvals
<code>driver.py</code>	<code>/api/v1/drivers</code>	DRIVER — trips, breaks, notifications
<code>hardware.py</code>	<code>/api/v1/hardware</code>	Hardware devices (API key auth, not JWT)
<code>websocket.py</code>	<code>/ws</code>	All roles — real-time channel

`models/models.py` — ORM Layer

One file containing all **22 SQLAlchemy table classes** and all Python enums. All models inherit from `Base` (defined in `database.py`).

Key enums: `UserRole` , `DriverStatus` , `VehicleStatus` , `TripStatus` , `ShiftType` , `RotationPosition` .

Tables are **never created by the app**. Schema is managed exclusively by Alembic (`alembic upgrade head`).

`schemas/schemas.py` — Validation Layer

One file with all Pydantic models. Each domain follows the pattern:

Schema Suffix	Purpose
*Base	Shared fields
*Create	POST input — includes validators (e.g. password strength)
*Update	PATCH input — all fields optional
*Response	Output shape — <code>from_attributes=True</code> for ORM serialization

All schemas inherit from `BaseSchema` :

```
class BaseSchema(BaseModel):  
    model_config = ConfigDict(from_attributes=True)
```

`services/` — Business Logic Layer

Services contain all domain logic and have **no knowledge of HTTP**. They receive DB sessions and domain objects, not `Request` objects. Routers call services; services never call routers.

File	What It Does
<code>scheduler.py</code>	APScheduler — 3 cron jobs: daily rotation (5:30 AM), cycling (every 5 min), midnight reset
<code>rotation_service.py</code>	Core 3-driver ping-pong algorithm
<code>break_service.py</code>	Break validation, fatigue scoring, mandatory break enforcement
<code>crowding_service.py</code>	<code>score = passenger_count / capacity × 100 ; ≥70% alert; ≥90% auto-dispatch</code>
<code>maintenance_service.py</code>	Request workflows + IoT threshold → auto EMERGENCY requests
<code>notification_service.py</code>	Create/deliver/read notifications + WebSocket broadcast

File	What It Does
audit_service.py	Logs every action with user ID, IP, entity, old/new values as JSON
report_service.py	Aggregates daily stats, generates PDF (reportlab) and CSV exports

`middleware/` — ASGI Middleware

`sanitization.py`

Pure ASGI middleware. Intercepts the raw request body **before** FastAPI reads it, recursively walks every JSON string field and runs `bleach.clean()` to strip HTML/script tags. Only applies to `POST/PUT/PATCH` with `Content-Type: application/json`.

`idempotency.py`

Caches responses keyed by an `Idempotency-Key` header to prevent duplicate operations on retried requests.

Full Request Lifecycle

